

Week	Year A	Year B	Year C
Ash Wed.	Mt. 6:1-6, 16-18 <i>Almsgiving, Prayer, and Fasting</i>		
1	Mt. 4:1-11 <i>The Temptation of Jesus</i>	Mk. 1:12-15 <i>The Temptation of Jesus</i>	Lk. 4:1-13 <i>The Temptation of Jesus</i>
2	Mt. 17:1-9 <i>Transfiguration</i>	Mk. 9:2-10 <i>Transfiguration</i>	Lk. 9:28b-36 <i>Transfiguration</i>
3	Jn. 4:5-42 <i>Samaritan woman</i>	Jn. 2:13-25 <i>Cleansing of the Temple</i>	Lk. 13:1-9 <i>Parable of the Fig Tree</i>
4	Jn. 9:1-41 <i>Healing of the blind man</i>	Jn. 3:14-21 <i>Nicodemus, "God so loved the world"</i>	Lk. 15:1-3, 11-32 <i>Lost Sheep, Prodigal Son</i>
5	Jn. 11:1-45 <i>Raising of Lazarus</i>	Jn. 12:20-33 <i>Glorification of the Son of God</i>	Jn. 8:1-11 <i>Woman caught in adultery</i>
6 (Palm Sunday)	Mt. 26:14-27:66 <i>The Passion</i>	Mk. 14:1-15, 47 <i>The Passion</i>	Lk. 22:14-23:56 <i>The Passion</i>

“The Glory of These Forty Days”

Text: *Clarum decus jejunii*, Gregory the Great, d. 604; tr. Maurice Frederick Bell, 1906

Tune: ERHALT UNS HERR, Joseph Klug, 1543

1. The glory of these forty days
we celebrate with songs of praise;
for Christ, by whom all things were
made,
Himself has fasted and has prayed.

2. Alone and fasting, Moses saw
the loving God who gave the law;
and to Elijah, fasting, came
the steeds and chariots of flame.

3. So Daniel trained his mystic sight,
delivered from the lions' might;
and John, the bridegroom's friend,
became
the herald of messiah's name.

4. Then grant us, Lord, like them, to be
full oft in fast and pray'r with Thee;
our spirits strengthen with Thy grace,
and give us joy to see Thy face.

5. O Father, Son, and Spirit blest,
to Thee be ev'ry pray'r addressed,
who art in threefold name adored
from age to age, the only Lord

Questions:

How does this hymn connect the Lenten fast with biblical figures who also fasted?

What does the hymn teach us about the purpose/benefit of fasting in the Christian life?

What is the role of Christ in this hymn?

“Again We Keep This Solemn Fast”

Text: *Ex more docti mystico*, Gregory the Great, d. 604; tr. Peter J. Scagnelli, 1975

Tune: ST. THOMAS, Aaron Williams, 1763

1. Again we keep this solemn fast,
a gift of faith from ages past,
this Lent which binds us lovingly
to faith and hope and charity.

2. The law and prophets from of old
in figured ways this Lent foretold
which Christ, all ages' Lord and guide,
in these last days has sanctified.

3. More sparing, therefore, let us make
the words we speak, the food we take,
our sleep, our laughter, ev'ry sense;
learn peace through holy penitence.

4. Let us avoid each harmful way
that lures the careless mind astray;
by watchful pray'r our spirits free
from scheming of the enemy.

5. We pray, O blessed three-in-one,
our God while endless ages run,
that this, our Lent of forty days,
may bring us growth and give You praise.

Questions:

Explain the line “which Christ, all ages’
Lord and guide, / in these last days has
sanctified.”

What practical advice does this hymn
give?

What does the hymn suggest about the
benefits of fasting, prayer, and penitence?

“Lord, Who Throughout These Forty Days”

Text: Claudia Frances Hernaman, 1873

Tune: ST. FLAVIAN, *John Day’s*
Psalter, London, 1562

1. Lord, who throughout these forty days,
for us did fast and pray,
teach us with You to mourn our sins
and close by You to stay.

2. As You with Satan did contend,
and did the vict’ry win,
O give us strength in You to fight,
in You to conquer sin.

3. As You did hunger bear, and thirst,
so teach us, gracious Lord,
to die to self and always live
by Your most holy Word.

4. And through these days of penitence,
and through Your passiontide,
forevermore, in life and death,
O Lord, with us abide.

5. Abide with us that when this life
of suffering is past,
an Easter of unending joy
we may attain at last!

Questions:

How does this hymn liken our own
struggles with Christ’s time in the
wilderness?

What specific parallels are drawn
between Christ’s experience and our
own?

What role does victory over temptation
play in the hymn’s message (both Christ’s
victory and our own)?

“Forty Days and Forty Nights”

Text: George Hunt Smyttan, 1856

Tune: HEINLEIN, Martin Herbst, 1676

1. Forty days and forty nights
You were fasting in the wild;
forty days and forty nights,
tempted, and yet undefiled.

2. Sunbeams scorching all the day;
chilly snowdrops nightly shed;
prowl’ing beasts about Your way;
stones, Your pillow; earth, Your bed.

3. Shall not we Your sorrow share
and from worldly joys abstain,
fasting with unceasing prayer,
strong with You to suffer pain?

4. Then if Satan on us press,
flesh or spirit to assail,
victor in the wilderness,
grant we may not faint nor fail!

5. So shall we have peace divine;
holier gladness ours shall be;
round us, too, shall angels shine,
such as served You faithfully.

6. Keep, O keep us, savior dear,
ever constant by Your side,
that with You we may appear
at th’eternal Eastertide.

Questions:

How does this hymn use imagery to describe the physical and spiritual challenges of Christ’s fast?

How does this hymn challenge us to approach suffering with a spirit of faith?

How does the final verse reinterpret the experience of those trials?

“Have Mercy on Us, Lord”

Text: *Attende Domine*, Latin, c. 10th century; tr. Melvin Farrell, 1977

Tune: ATTENDE DOMINE, *Paris Processionale*, Paris, 1824

R/ Have mercy on us, Lord, Jesus our savior;
burdened with sin, we implore You.

1. O great redeemer, king of all creation,
as we are sinners, we deserve Your judgment:
Jesus, be gracious; hear our pray’r of sorrow. R/

2. Exalted savior, cornerstone of heaven,
gate of salvation, way to life immortal:
send forth Your Spirit, heal Your humbled people! R/

3. We beg You, Jesus, God immense in power,
listen in kindness as we ask forgiveness:
though sin condemns us, You are strong to save us! R/

4. We stand convicted, owning our offenses;
guilty before You, yet we seek Your pardon:
O gentle savior, great is Your compassion. R/

5. Remember, Jesus, You gave all to save us;
dying for sinners, You endured Your passion.
Savior immortal, grant Your gift of freedom! R/

Questions:

What emotions does the hymn evoke for you?

What titles and images of Christ are used and what do they reveal about Him?

What role does the refrain play in shaping the overall message of the hymn?

“My Song is Love Unknown”

Text: Samuel Crossman, 1664

Tune: LOVE UNKNOWN, John Ireland,
1918

1. My song is love unknown,
my savior’s love to me,
love to the loveless shown
that they might lovely be.
Oh, who am I
that, for my sake,
my Lord should take
frail flesh and die?

2. He came from His blest throne,
salvation to bestow;
but men made strange and none
the longed-for Christ would know.
But, oh, my friend,
my friend indeed,
who at my need
His life did spend!

3. Sometimes they strew His way
and His sweet praises sing,
resounding all the day
hosannas to their king.
Then, “Crucify!”
is all their breath,
and for His death
they thirst and cry.

4. Why, what hath my Lord done?
What makes this rage and spite?
He made the lame to run,
He gave the blind their sight.

Sweet injuries!
Yet they at these
themselves displease
and ‘gainst Him rise.

5. They rise, and needs will have
my dear Lord, made away;
a murderer they save,
the prince of life they slay.
Yet, cheerful, He
to suff’ring goes,
that He His foes
from thence might free.

6. In life, no house, no home
my Lord on earth might have;
in death no friendly tomb
but what a stranger gave.
What may I say?
Heav’n was His home
but mine the tomb
wherein He lay.

7. Here might I stay and sing,
no story so divine!
Never was love, dear king,
never was grief like Thine.
This is my friend,
in whose sweet praise
I all my days
could gladly spend!

Questions:

What does the hymn teach about Christ –

His ministry, mission, and passion?

How does this hymn use contrast?

How is 1st and 3rd person language used?